

SERVING PLAN 4 SERVING PLAN

Meatball Parm Heroes

with Fire-Roasted Tomato Sauce and Charred Broccoli

There's something irresistible about a crispy, saucy meatball hero. Here, we're giving the comfort dish a few cheffy upgrades, swapping out the marinara for garlicky, fire-roasted tomato sauce, and blending the beef meatballs with ricotta, Parmesan, parsley, and breadcrumbs. Layered with mozzarella and provolone and toasted until melty, these sandwiches prove that not all heroes wear capes.

45-55 minutes 840 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- 1½ pounds broccoli
- ¼ ounce parsley, divided
- 4 cloves garlic, divided
- 1 yellow onion
- 4 French bread rolls
- 1 ounce grated Parmesan cheese, divided
- 1½ pounds ground beef
- 2 tablespoons ricotta cheese
- ⅓ cup breadcrumbs
- ½ teaspoon crushed red pepper
- 2 14½-ounce cans fire-roasted tomatoes
- 6 ounces shredded mozzarella and provolone cheese blend

You'll Need

- olive oil
- 2 eggs
- kosher salt
- black pepper
- aluminum foil
- 12" large pan
- baking sheet

Recipe Tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

If you have any remaining stem leftover from the broccoli, feel free to peel it and enjoy it as a snack.

The foil will hold your sandwiches in place after they're filled with toppings. Unwrap the rolls just enough so that you can stuff them while still maintaining their shape.

USDA recommends cooking ground beef to 160°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

1741-3168-4P



1. Prepare Ingredients

Preheat oven to 450°F. Rinse **broccoli** and halve lengthwise. Cut lengthwise again into 1 inch-wide florets with long stems (see Recipe Tip). Rinse **parsley** and roughly chop leaves, discarding stems. Mince **garlic**. Peel **onion**, halve, and thinly slice. Slice **rolls** open horizontally, splitting partway but leaving 1 edge intact. Drizzle cut sides with **olive oil** and sprinkle with **half of Parmesan** and **half of garlic**. Close **rolls** and wrap each in foil. Set aside.



2. Form Meatballs

Pat **beef** dry with paper towel. In a large bowl, combine **beef**, **ricotta**, **breadcrumbs**, **half of parsley**, **remaining Parmesan**, **2 eggs**, **1 teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper** as desired, then add **beef**. Using your hands, mix well, then form into 16 equal balls, about 2 inches thick.



3. Sear Meatballs

Heat **2 tablespoons olive oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **meatballs** and sear, flipping occasionally, until browned on all sides, about 10 minutes total. Transfer to a paper-towel lined plate to drain and set aside. Discard almost all of fat from pan (pour the cooled fat into a heatproof container, then dispose in the garbage), leaving behind a thin layer for Step 5.



4. Char Broccoli

While meatballs sear, pat **broccoli** very dry with paper towel and place on a baking sheet. Toss **broccoli** with **2 tablespoons olive oil**, **½ teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper** as desired. Arrange in a single layer, spacing apart, and roast until cooked through and very charred, about 15 minutes. Place **rolls** in oven to warm through until Step 6.



5. Finish Meatballs

While broccoli chars, add **onion** to pan from meatballs over medium-high heat. Cook until softened, about 5 minutes. Add **crushed red pepper** (skip or use half for less heat) and **remaining garlic**. Cook until fragrant, 1 minute. Add **fire-roasted tomatoes** and cook until slightly reduced, about 4 minutes. Season with **¼ teaspoon salt** and **black pepper**. Return **meatballs** to pan, stirring to coat. Cook until sauce has thickened, 3 minutes.



6. Toast and Plate Heroes

Partially unwrap **rolls** to reveal cut centers, keeping bottoms and sides cradled with foil (see Recipe Tip). Top **rolls** with **meatballs**, spoon over **sauce**, and sprinkle over **mozzarella and provolone**. Bake until cheese is melted and bubbling, 5 minutes. Garnish **heroes** with remaining parsley and transfer to serving plates with **broccoli**. Dig in!

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